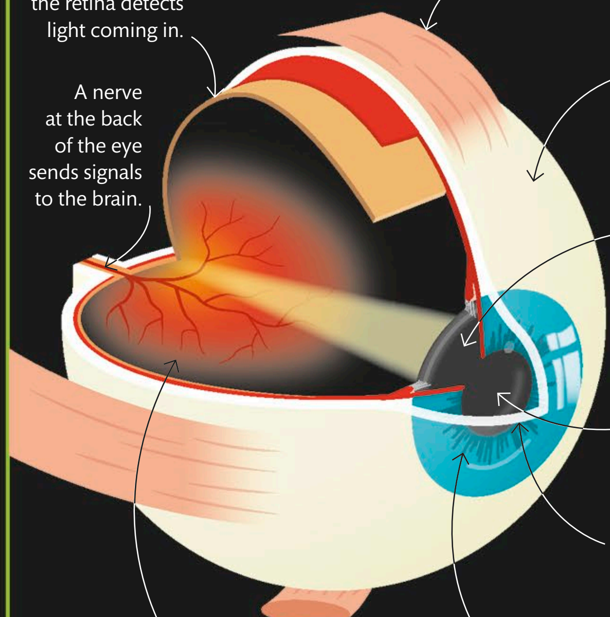
IDENTITY CHECKS

BIOMETRICS

Every day, people access their mobile phones or tablets using biometrics—body measurements. Each person has many unique physical and behavioral characteristics, such as their fingerprints, facial features, tone of voice, or even the pattern of a part of their eye called the iris. Biometrics uses these traits to digitally identify a person by checking them against a database containing information about the features of many users. This technology is used by companies to verify employees and by the police.

THE HUMAN EYE

Our eyes turn reflected light into the images we see. Incoming light passes through the lens of the eye and focuses on the retina at the back. This produces electrical signals that are sent to the brain, which then works out what we are seeing.



Iris scan
The colored part of the eye called the iris is scanned in this computer image. The different colors in the iris create a pattern unique to each individual, which can be used to accurately identify them.